Investor Platform: Developer Handover and Build Guide

A self-contained brief for the product designer and tester, delivered in phases

Future Studio · Draft v2 · 5 November 2026

1. Read this first

This document is complete on its own. The decisions, data, flows, metrics, design standard and test plan are all inside it. Nothing refers to any other document.

You do two jobs, in this order, **in every phase**:

1. **Product designer.** Arrange and improve the screens and flows of that phase, following the standards below.
2. **User tester.** Test what you built, measure it, fix it, and prove that nothing that already worked has broken.

The work is split into **seven phases (0 to 6)**. Each phase is small enough to design, build, test and release on its own. Finish a phase, pass its exit gate, release it behind a flag, then start the next. Do not start a phase before the previous gate is passed.

Context. Future Studio is a venture studio in Benin Republic. Its Investor OS lets approved investors find startups that are raising funds, ask Future Studio for introductions, talk to founders and invest. Most of today's dashboard already exists. Your job is to restructure it and add what is missing without breaking what investors already use.

Why this order. Recording data comes first (Phase 1), because the metrics need history that cannot be recreated later. The dashboard is arranged next (Phase 2), so every new feature lands in a clean structure. Features then follow the order an investor meets them: introductions (3), conversation (4), investment (5), and finally onboarding and release (6).

2. The phases at a glance

Phase	Name	What it delivers	Exit gate in one line
0	Prepare	Staging site, demo data, a recorded baseline of how everything works today	Baseline reviewed and approved

Phase	Name	What it delivers	Exit gate in one line
1	Foundation	Activity log, visibility modes, hidden-data protection in the API, feature flags, language scaffolding	Log verified, no hidden field ever returned, regression passes
2	Dashboard redesign	New layout, Action strip, number cards, charts, one interest button, states, mobile, French and English	Usability study passed, regression passes
3	Deal flow and introductions	Studio deal flow, pitch deck, introduction requests, studio review queue, decline reasons	Tasks pass, security checks pass
4	Conversation and meetings	Messaging entry points, 6-hour email, scheduling, calendar, emails, feedback	Tasks pass, emails verified in both languages
5	Investment confirmation and metrics	Pending-approval investments, financing record, studio metric views	Metrics reconcile with the log
6	Onboarding and release	New application link, invitations, NDA step, first-run guide, full bilingual pass, staged rollout	Full release criteria met

Every phase section has the same parts: **Goal, Design, Build, Data, Test, Exit gate.**

3. Rules that must not break

1. **Reuse before building.** Search the code for an existing function, table, route or screen before creating one. Extend it. Do not replace it.
2. **Keep working exactly as today:** the application form and approval automation, provisioning of the investor profile, the activation email, password setup, login and session, the pipeline stages, watchlist, compare bar, recommendations, and the dashboard endpoint.

3. **Keep the identity model.** An investor is a context, not a role string. The investor profile row is the entitlement. Keep investor self-service authorization.
4. **Hidden data never leaves the server.** Fields investors must not see are removed in the API response, not just hidden on screen.
5. **Database changes are additive only:** new columns and tables. Never drop or rename. Follow the existing self-healing pattern (ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS).
6. **Every new behaviour sits behind a feature flag** so it can be switched off without a deployment.
7. **A failed secondary write is logged to the Errors register** and never breaks the main action.
8. **The activity log is immutable** and is written by the server, never by the browser.
9. **Keep the existing visual kit (`stf-*`)** as the base and extend it.
10. **No phase may remove an action investors use today.** If a change replaces a button, the old function must still be reachable.

4. Words used in this document

Term	Meaning
Studio	Future Studio staff and administrators
Venture	A startup in the studio's portfolio
Venture stage	Idea, Validation, Early Traction, Growth or Scaling. An internal studio measure. Investors in Deal flow only mode never see it.
Deal flow	The set of ventures the studio has decided to present to investors because they want to raise funds. Only the studio adds a venture to deal flow.
Studio pipeline	Every venture the studio works with, each with a venture stage
Investor pipeline	An investor's own list of ventures and their own stages (Interested, Due Diligence, Invested and so on). Exists today.
Visibility mode	A setting on each investor, set by the studio. **Deal flow only** (default) or **Full pipeline** (see section 8).

Term	Meaning
Introduction	A request by an investor to be introduced to a venture. It goes to the studio, never directly to the venture.
Workspace	The existing space that links one investor and one venture once the studio approves an introduction
Pitch deck	A separate fundraising deck for a venture in deal flow
Activity log	A server-written record of every investor action with its time
Feature flag	A switch that turns a new behaviour on or off

5. Decisions already made

#	Decision	What it means
1	**Two visibility modes**	The studio sets each investor's mode. The investor cannot change it.
2	**Only the studio puts a venture in deal flow**	The studio enters the amount being raised and publishes the pitch deck. Founders cannot do this.
3	**Introductions go only through the studio**	The investor requests, the studio approves or declines, and only then can investor and venture talk directly.
4	**Investments need studio confirmation**	An investor can say 'I have invested' with amount, instrument and date. It shows as **Pending approval from Future Studio** until the studio confirms. Only then does it count anywhere.
5	**Every decline needs a reason, from whoever declines**	The reason is shown to the person affected. A separate internal note stays studio-only.

#	Decision	What it means
6	**One button for interest**	'I am interested' and 'Add to pipeline' are the same action.
7	**Messaging uses the existing messaging system**	A Message button appears in several places. If a message is unread for 6 hours, the recipient gets one email naming the sender.
8	**The NDA is separate and not yet drafted**	Build the acceptance step and keep it switched off until the text exists.
9	**Founder count and founders' country use existing venture data**	Use the founders already recorded for each venture. No new data entry.
10	**Why now and use of funds come from the pitch deck**	Do not build separate fields for them.
11	**The whole platform is in French and English**	Every screen, email, notification and calendar invite.
12	**Investor types are not limited**	A studio-editable list plus a free-text 'other'.
13	**Time to close: the clock start is a setting**	Default is the first introduction request. The studio will decide later. Because every step is time-stamped, changing it recalculates everything.
14	**All investor activity is logged**	The studio can see who looked at what, and when. Investors cannot see the log.

6. The investor case study

Who they are. Investors can be any type: angels, funds, family offices, development finance institutions, foundations, corporates and others. They are busy, often outside Benin, often on a phone, and may prefer French or English. They know nothing about the studio's internal terms, so every screen must make sense without training.

What they want. To find ventures worth their time quickly. To judge a venture from its pitch deck without wading through detail. To get a trusted introduction, not a cold contact. To keep track of what they are doing and what is waiting on them. To know the

status of every request without asking the studio.

The journey:

Step	What the investor does	What the system does	Built in
1. Apply	Fills the investor form from the website link or an invitation	Saves the submission and queues it for review	Phase 6 (form exists today)
2. Approval	Waits	Studio approves. Profile, preferences and activation email are created.	Exists
3. Activate	Sets a password	Account becomes active	Exists
4. First login	Accepts the NDA, sees a welcome and a 3-step checklist	Records acceptance with version and time	Phase 6
5. Discover	Browses ventures their mode allows, searches, filters	Returns only allowed fields	Phases 1 and 2
6. Evaluate	Opens a venture. The pitch deck opens first.	Logs the view and the deck open	Phase 3
7. Show interest	Presses 'I am interested'	Adds to pipeline at Interested, logs interest	Phase 2
8. Request introduction	Presses 'Request introduction', adds a note	Sends it to the studio. Investor sees 'Request sent'.	Phase 3
9. Studio decision	Waits, sees the status	Studio approves, or declines with a reason	Phase 3
10. Converse	Messages the venture and books a meeting	Opens the thread, handles time slots, calendar and emails	Phase 4
11. Evaluate further	Moves the venture through their own stages	Existing stage machine	Exists

Step	What the investor does	What the system does	Built in
12. Invest	Marks 'I have invested' with the details	Shows Pending approval. Studio confirms.	Phase 5
13. Follow up	Sees the confirmed investment	Financing record created for the venture	Phase 5

Scenarios to design and test for:

1. A brand-new investor with an empty dashboard.
2. An investor in Deal flow only mode, who sees only ventures that are raising.
3. An investor in Full pipeline mode, who also sees venture stages.
4. An investor whose introduction was approved and who now wants to message and book a time.
5. An investor whose introduction was declined and who needs to understand why.
6. An investor who marked an investment and is waiting for confirmation.
7. An investor on a phone with a slow connection.
8. An investor who prefers French.
9. An investor with no recommendations because nothing matches their preferences.
10. An investor returning after weeks, who needs to see what changed.

7. Phase 0: Prepare

Goal. Know exactly how things work today, so you can prove nothing broke.

Do:

1. Set up a **staging site** separate from live, with its own database.
2. Create **demo data**: one investor in each mode, one brand-new investor with an empty dashboard, one French-speaking investor, at least six ventures (three of them with a logo, description and sample deck), and a few pipeline and watchlist entries.
3. Read the existing code for: the application form and approval automation, investor provisioning, activation and login, the dashboard endpoint and its payload builder, the Discover endpoint, recommendation scoring, pipeline and watchlist routes, the compare bar, relationship workspaces and meetings, and the messaging system. Write a one-page note of what each does.

4. Record the **baseline**: screenshots of every investor screen on desktop and phone, and a pass or fail checklist of every action investors use today: log in, dashboard loads, search, each filter, open a venture, add to pipeline, change a stage, toggle watchlist, compare up to four, see recommendations, edit profile, edit preferences.

Test. Run the baseline checklist twice to confirm it is repeatable.

Exit gate. The product owner reviews and approves the baseline and the demo data.

8. Phase 1: Foundation

Goal. Make the platform ready: record every action, protect hidden data, and prepare the switches. Investors see almost no change.

Design. Little visual design is needed. Design the studio's control for visibility mode on the investor record (one clear selector with the two modes explained in plain words).

Build:

1. **Activity log.** Create the table in A.8. Write the events that already exist today: login, list viewed, search used, venture viewed, watchlist added and removed, pipeline added, pipeline stage changed, compare used. Events are written by the server and never edited. A repeat view of the same venture within 30 minutes does not count as a new view. Mark studio staff and test accounts so they can be excluded from metrics.
2. **Visibility mode.** Add the column and the studio control. Apply it in the dashboard and Discover endpoints. Log each change.
3. **Hidden-data protection.** Make the API return only the fields in the table below. This is the most important task in this phase.
4. **Profile additions.** Add the columns in A.1 (type, source, approval and login dates, language, terms fields).
5. **Feature flags.** One flag per new behaviour in phases 2 to 6, all off.
6. **Language scaffolding.** Move text into translation files, add the language preference to the profile and a switch in the header. (French content is completed in Phase 2.)
7. **Metric settings table** (A.9).

What an investor's API response may contain:

Field	Deal flow only	Full pipeline
Logo, name, brief description, industry	Yes	Yes
Number of founders and founders' country (from existing venture data)	Yes	Yes
Venture stage	**No**	Yes, as a label with a one-line meaning
Amount being raised	Yes, for ventures in deal flow	Yes, for ventures in deal flow
Pitch deck	Yes, for ventures in deal flow	Yes, for ventures in deal flow
Founder names and roles	Only if the studio switches this on for that venture	Same
Ventures not in deal flow	Not visible	Visible as cards only: no deck, no amount, no introduction button
The investor's own history with a venture (interest date, introduction status, meetings, private notes)	Yes	Yes

Never returned to any investor: customer counts, growth, retention, revenue, burn, runway, north-star value, traffic light, completion index, narratives, internal notes, other investors' activity, contact details of founders, and internal decline notes. This applies to every endpoint: search, compare, recommendations, venture detail and exports.

Data. A.1, A.8, A.9.

Test:

1. For each demo investor, call every investor endpoint and inspect the raw responses. No field outside the table above appears.
2. Each logged action produces exactly one log row with the right investor, venture and time.

3. Switching an investor's mode changes what they see on their next request and logs the change.
4. Run the full baseline checklist. Everything still passes.

Exit gate. All four tests pass. No critical issue open.

9. Phase 2: Dashboard redesign

Goal. Give investors a clear, well-arranged dashboard on the data that already exists, with every current action still working. This is the main product-design phase.

Design steps:

1. **Audit** the current dashboard: list every block, what it does and who uses it.
2. **Wireframes** at 1280, 768 and 360 pixels wide, for the dashboard and every tab. **Review 1:** layout, with the product owner.
3. **High-fidelity screens** for each tab, with all states (below). **Review 2:** each tab, with the product owner.
4. Build only after the wireframe for that tab is approved.

9.1 Layout

Sidebar on desktop, **bottom bar** on a phone: Dashboard, Messages (hidden until Phase 4), Profile. A **language switch (EN | FR)** sits in the header.

Dashboard page, top to bottom:

1. **Welcome line** with the investor's name.
2. **Action needed strip.** One row of cards, each a single call to action. Show only items that exist. The items appear as the phases deliver them: an introduction waiting for the studio and an approved one with 'Schedule meeting' (Phase 3), meeting proposals, meetings in the next 7 days and unread messages (Phase 4), an investment pending confirmation (Phase 5), the NDA to accept (Phase 6).
3. **Number cards** (9.3).
4. **Recommended ventures:** a horizontal row of cards.
5. **Charts** (9.4).
6. **Tabs: Discover, Pipeline, Watchlist** now. **Introductions** is added in Phase 3 and **Meetings** in Phase 4.

On a phone, the same blocks stack in the same order, with the Action strip first and the charts collapsed below the tabs.

9.2 Tab contents

Tab	Contents
Discover	Search, filters (industry, country, and in Full pipeline mode venture stage and funding range), venture cards, compare bar (up to 4, showing only allowed fields)
Pipeline	The investor's own stages. One card per venture with its stage and the date it entered that stage. Message and Schedule buttons are added in Phase 4.
Watchlist	Saved ventures with a note field and an 'I am interested' button
Introductions	Added in Phase 3
Meetings	Added in Phase 4

Venture card: logo, name, number of founders, founders' country, brief description, industry. In Full pipeline mode the card also shows the venture stage as a label with a one-line meaning. **Venture page:** the same fields plus, when Phase 3 ships, the pitch deck first. Until then, the page shows the card fields and the investor's own activity panel (interest date, notes).

9.3 Number cards

Card	Definition
In pipeline	Pipeline entries that are active (not declined, not in history)
Watchlist	Ventures saved
Invested	Investments recorded (from Phase 5: only investments **confirmed** by the studio, with a smaller line 'N pending confirmation')

Card	Definition
Introductions	Active requests. Appears in Phase 3.
Meetings	Confirmed upcoming meetings. Appears in Phase 4.

Each card is clickable and opens the matching tab, already filtered.

9.4 Charts

Keep charts few, readable and honest. Every chart has a title that states what it shows, a text or table alternative, and a designed empty state ('Nothing here yet. Add a venture to your pipeline to see it.').

Chart	Type	Data and formula	Source
Pipeline by stage	Horizontal bar	Count of the investor's pipeline entries in each of their own stages	Existing pipeline stats
Ventures by industry	Horizontal bar	Count of ventures in the investor's pipeline and watchlist, grouped by industry	Pipeline, watchlist, ventures
Activity over time	Column chart, last 12 weeks	Per week: ventures viewed, interests, introduction requests (stacked)	Activity log

The pipeline chart uses the **investor's own stages**, so it never reveals a venture's studio stage. Do not rely on colour alone. No 3D, no gauges, no pie charts. Introduction requests appear in the activity chart from Phase 3.

9.5 States every screen and component must have

State	Standard
Loading	Skeleton placeholders in the final layout. Keep today's cache-first paint, then refresh in the background.
Empty	A friendly line saying why, and one clear action

State	Standard
Error	A plain message, what to do, and a Retry button. Never raw error text.
Partial	If one block fails (for example recommendations), the rest still loads
Offline or slow	Keep showing the last loaded data with a note
Pending	Clear status labels with an icon and text, never colour alone

9.6 Design standards

- **Mobile-first and responsive.** Test at 360, 768 and 1280 pixels wide.
- **Accessibility:** meet WCAG 2.2 level AA. Text contrast at least 4.5:1, full keyboard use with a visible focus, a label on every control, touch targets at least 44 by 44 pixels, charts with text alternatives.
- **Performance** on a mid-range phone over 4G: Largest Contentful Paint under 2.5 seconds, Interaction to Next Paint under 200 ms, Cumulative Layout Shift under 0.1. Lazy-load images and decks.
- **Consistency:** one component per job (one card, one button set, one status badge), reused everywhere. Use the `stf-*` kit and extend it.
- **Clear wording:** plain words, one idea per label, the same status names on every screen.
- **Confirm destructive actions** such as withdrawing. Allow undo where possible.

9.7 Behaviour changes in this phase

1. **One interest button.** It reads 'I am interested'. Pressing it adds the venture to the pipeline at Interested (as today) and logs `interest_expressed`. If the venture is already in the pipeline, the button shows its current stage.
2. **Recommendation scoring.** Today the score is industry 30, country 25, stage 20, ticket fit 15, completion bonus 10. Change it to the table below. The completion index is hidden from investors and empty for some ventures, so the bonus is removed. Match reasons must never mention the venture stage in Deal flow only mode.

Signal	Deal flow only	Full pipeline
Industry	40	30
Country	30	25
Venture stage	0	20
Ticket fit (investor's minimum and maximum against the amount being raised)	30	25
Completion bonus	Removed	Removed

3. **Private notes** on any venture, visible only to the investor. Today notes exist only on invested ventures.
4. **Profile additions.** Keep bio, website, LinkedIn, photo and investment philosophy. Add a **logo** and a **past investments** field. Investors edit their own preferences (this works today).
5. **French and English** for every existing screen, status, error and chart label.

Data. A.1 (language). Event: `interest_expressed`.

Test. Tasks T2, T4, T10, T11, T12 and T13 (Reference D). Then the usability study (5 people), the accessibility checks, the performance checks and the full baseline checklist.

Exit gate. No critical or high issue open. At least 90% of tasks completed without help. SUS of 80 or more. Baseline checklist passes. WCAG 2.2 AA checks pass on the dashboard and each tab. Performance targets met. French complete on every existing screen.

10. Phase 3: Deal flow and introductions

Goal. Let the studio present ventures that want to raise funds, let investors see the pitch deck first, and let investors ask for introductions through the studio.

Design: the studio's Add to deal flow screen, the studio's introduction review queue, the venture page with the deck first, the Request introduction button and message box, and the Introductions tab with its statuses.

10.1 Studio flow: put a venture in deal flow

1. The studio opens a venture and clicks **Add to deal flow**.

2. The studio enters the **amount being raised** and the currency (an instrument is optional).
3. The studio uploads the **fundraising pitch deck**. It is a separate file from any other deck. The founder may supply the file, but only the studio publishes it. 'Why now' and 'use of funds' are not separate fields: the deck carries them.
4. The entry goes **live** only when the amount is set and a deck is published. Events: `deal_flow_opened`, `deck_published`.
5. The studio can pause or close the entry. Closing needs a reason: raised, withdrawn, expired or other. Event: `deal_flow_closed`.

Reuse the existing fundraising campaigns if they can hold these fields. Otherwise add the table in A.4.

10.2 Investor flow: view and request

1. The investor sees ventures according to their mode (section 8). Deal flow cards show the amount being raised.
2. Opening a venture logs `venture_viewed`. The **pitch deck opens first** and logs `deck_opened`. Closing it logs `deck_closed` with the seconds spent.
3. The deck is **view-only** inside the platform, watermarked with the investor's name and the date. Downloads are off unless the studio switches them on for that deck.
4. The investor presses **Request introduction** and may add a note (up to 1,000 characters). The screen shows 'Request sent'. Event: `intro_requested`. **The venture does not see it.**
5. The request enters the **studio review queue**. Opening it logs `intro_review_started`.
6. The studio **approves** or **declines**.
   - **Approve:** the system opens or reuses the workspace between the investor and the venture, grants both sides access, and notifies both. Event: `intro_approved`. Messaging and meetings arrive in Phase 4.
   - **Decline:** a reason is required (10.3). Event: `intro_declined`.
7. The investor can **withdraw** a request before it is decided. Event: `intro_withdrawn`.

10.3 Decline reasons

A reason is **required** whenever anything is declined. The person declining picks a reason from a list and may add an internal note. **The reason is shown to the person affected. The note is studio-only.** The studio edits the lists, which exist in both languages. The API

returns the reason and never the note.

Who declines	What	Suggested reasons
Studio	Introduction request	Not a fit with the investor's focus; The venture is not ready for introductions now; The raise is paused or closed; More information is needed from the investor; Other
Studio	Investment claim (Phase 5)	The amount or date does not match our records; We cannot verify it; Other
Studio	Investor application	Not a fit for the network; Incomplete information; Other
Investor	Passing on a venture	Outside my focus; Ticket size; Geography; Timing; Team; Other

10.4 Introductions tab

One row per request: venture, date, status and any reason. Statuses: **Request sent, Under review, Approved, Declined (with reason), Withdrawn**. Status names are identical on every screen. When a request is approved, the row gains a Message button in Phase 4.

10.5 Emails

Acknowledgement when a request is submitted. Notification when it is approved. Notification when it is declined, showing the reason. All in the recipient's language.

Data. A.4 (deal flow entries and decks), A.5 (introduction requests), A.11 (decline reasons). Events: `deal_flow_opened`, `deal_flow_closed`, `deck_published`, `deck_opened`, `deck_closed`, `intro_requested`, `intro_review_started`, `intro_approved`, `intro_declined`, `intro_withdrawn`.

Test. Tasks T3, T5, T6 and T8. Security checks: an investor in Deal flow only mode cannot reach a venture outside deal flow by guessing its address. A founder cannot see a request before approval. The internal note is never returned. The watermark shows the right name. Then a lighter usability study (3 people plus 2 internal) and the baseline checklist.

Exit gate. Tasks pass. No critical or high issue open. Security checks pass. Baseline checklist passes. Emails verified in both languages.

11. Phase 4: Conversation and meetings

Goal. After the studio approves an introduction, investor and venture can talk directly and book a meeting, with Future Studio sending the confirmations.

Design: the Message button in every place it appears, the Messages screen, the scheduling screens for both sides, the Meetings tab, and the confirmation and reminder emails.

11.1 Messaging

- **Reuse the existing messaging system.** Inspect it first and extend it. Do not build a second one.
- Messaging works between an investor and a venture **only after the studio approves their introduction**.
- There is **one conversation per investor and venture pair**. The same conversation opens from every entry point.
- A **Message** button appears on the venture page, on the Introductions list, on the Pipeline card, in the Meetings tab, in the workspace, and in the Messages item of the sidebar.
- Unread counts show on the sidebar item and in the Action strip.
- **Notification rule:** if a message is still **unread after 6 hours**, send one email to the recipient. It says who it is from: 'You have a new message from [investor name]' or 'from [venture name]'. Send at most one email per conversation per 6-hour window. Do not put the message text in the email. Link to the conversation.
- Events: `message_sent`, `message_read`, `message_email_sent`.

11.2 Scheduling a meeting

1. After approval, both sides see a **Schedule meeting** button.
2. Either side proposes up to 3 time slots in their own timezone. Times are stored in UTC. Event: `slot_proposed`.
3. The other side accepts one or proposes new times. Event: `slot_accepted`.
4. When a slot is accepted, the meeting is **confirmed** and appears on both users' calendars in the platform, shown in each person's own timezone. Event: `meeting_confirmed`.

5. **Future Studio sends the confirmation email** to both parties and copies the studio. It contains the date, the time in each recipient's timezone, the duration, the video link and a calendar file. Event: `meeting_email_sent`.
6. Reminders go out 24 hours and 1 hour before (switchable off). Event: `meeting_reminder_sent`.
7. Rescheduling or cancelling creates a new event and a new email (`meeting_rescheduled`, `meeting_cancelled`). Either side can cancel.
8. After the time passes, the studio records the result: held or no-show, plus an outcome code (follow up, not a fit, wants more information, moving to due diligence) and a note. Events: `meeting_held`, `meeting_no_show`.
9. After a held meeting the investor sees a short feedback form: interested, not interested, or need more information, plus an optional note.

Reuse the existing relationship meetings and the upcoming meetings list. Add the tables in A.6 only for what they cannot hold.

11.3 Meetings tab

Upcoming and past meetings, time in the investor's timezone, Reschedule and Cancel buttons, a Join link, and the feedback form after a meeting.

Data. A.6 (time slots and meetings). Events as listed above.

Test. Task T7. Check that a message unread for 6 hours triggers exactly one email, naming the right sender, in the recipient's language. Check timezones with an investor in a different timezone from the venture. Check that the calendar file opens in common calendar apps. Check reschedule and cancel. Then a lighter usability study (3 plus 2) and the baseline checklist.

Exit gate. Tasks pass. No critical or high issue open. Emails verified in both languages on desktop and mobile mail apps. Baseline checklist passes.

12. Phase 5: Investment confirmation and metrics

Goal. Make investment records trustworthy, create the venture's financing record automatically, and give the studio the metric views.

Design: the 'I have invested' form and its Pending and Confirmed states on the investor's Pipeline and dashboard, the studio's confirmation queue, and the studio's metric dashboards.

12.1 Investment confirmation flow

1. The investor presses **I have invested** on a venture in their pipeline and enters the amount, currency, instrument and date.
2. The pipeline card shows **Pending approval from Future Studio**. The Action strip and the Invested card's pending line show it too.
3. Nothing else fires yet: no decision record, no campaign update, no financing event, no notification.
4. The studio sees it in a review queue and **confirms** (it may correct the figures) or **rejects with a required reason**.
5. On **confirm:** the status becomes Confirmed, the existing side effects fire, the venture's **outside financing event** is created automatically (type, amount, date, source = the investor), and `investment_recorded` is logged. The investor is notified.
6. On **reject:** the investor sees the reason and can resubmit.
7. If a pair ends without investment, a reason is required (`pipeline_declined` or `pipeline_withdrawn`).

Implementation note. Do not change the pipeline stage machine. Add a confirmation status on the pipeline entry (pending, confirmed, rejected) and move the existing investment side effects behind the confirmation. Today an investor can set Invested alone, which creates an investment record without checking it. This phase closes that gap. Plan how already-recorded investments are treated (suggested: mark existing ones confirmed after the studio reviews them once).

12.2 Studio metric views

All metrics are defined in Reference C. Build:

- **Investor dashboard for the studio:** metrics A1 to E8 with a date filter and the standard cuts (investor type, investor country, venture industry, venture, deal flow entry, visibility mode).
- **Per-investor page:** the investor's full activity timeline: every venture viewed, every introduction, meetings, pipeline stages.
- **Per-venture page:** who viewed, who requested introductions, outcomes.
- **Quarterly capital report:** F1 to F8.
- **Exports:** a CSV of the activity log, and of each metric with its formula.

Data. A.7, A.8, A.9. Events: `investment_recorded`, `pipeline_declined`, `pipeline_withdrawn`.

Test. Task T9. A claimed investment does not appear in any metric, the financing record or the venture's outside financing until confirmed. A rejection shows the reason and no side effects fired. Reconcile: for a sample month, count log rows by event type and compare them with the dashboard numbers. Check each metric against a hand calculation on the demo data. Then a lighter usability study (3 plus 2) and the baseline checklist.

Exit gate. Tasks pass. Every metric in Reference C that can be calculated at this point matches its hand calculation. No critical or high issue open. Baseline checklist passes.

13. Phase 6: Onboarding and release

Goal. Finish the front door and release safely to all investors.

Design: the public application page, the invitation email, the NDA screen, the first-run welcome and checklist, and the studio's investor administration screens.

13.1 Application form and the new link

The old public sign-up stays retired. The studio creates a **new run** of the existing Investor Application form from its side and gets a new public link. Use the existing seed function and the existing approval automation: when the studio approves a submission, the investor is created and appears on the admin investors page automatically.

The website gets a page that explains the investor network and links to the form. **New behaviour on approval:** set the visibility mode to the studio default, record `approved_at`, and log `application_approved`.

Section	Fields
Account	Full name, email, phone
Organization	Organization name, **investor type** (from the studio's list plus Other), website, country, LinkedIn
Preferences	Industries, countries, stages, minimum and maximum ticket size, currency. Stages are stored but used only in Full pipeline mode.
Experience	Years investing, number of investments, notable investments (optional), self-declaration of investor status

Section	Fields
Source	How did you hear about us. Filled automatically from an invitation.
Language	English or French

Whether investors need more verification is a legal question for the studio and its advisor.

13.2 Invitations

1. The studio enters an email and a name on the admin investors page and clicks **Invite**.
2. The system creates an invitation with a token and emails the **same form link** with the token attached. Event: `invitation_sent`.
3. Opening the link logs `invitation_opened`. Submitting logs `invitation_submitted` and sets the profile source to invited.
4. From there it is the same as a normal application. **The studio still approves.** An optional setting can auto-approve invited investors. It is **off** by default.
5. Expired or revoked tokens show a clear message and still allow a normal application.

13.3 Investor types

The studio manages the list of investor types (seed values: angel, venture fund, family office, development finance institution, foundation, corporate, accelerator, other). Never hard-code them. Each exists in both languages.

13.4 NDA step

- **Terms of Use** and **NDA** are two separate documents, each with its own version.
- Once the NDA flag is on, a new or existing investor must accept it on login before seeing any venture. Store the time, the version and the language shown. A new version requires acceptance again.
- The NDA is **not drafted yet**. Build the step with placeholder text, keep the flag **off**, and do not block any current investor until the studio has legal text in English and French and switches it on.

13.5 First-run guide

A short welcome note and a dismissible 3-step checklist: complete your profile, browse deal flow, request an introduction. A brand-new investor with nothing in their dashboard sees a one-line hint of what they can do above the empty Pipeline and Watchlist.

13.6 Full French and English pass

Every screen, button, status, error, chart label, email, notification, calendar invite and list the studio edits exists in both languages. Emails and notifications use the recipient's language. Dates and times follow the language (24-hour time in French) and the user's timezone. Test layouts with French text, which is usually longer. A **pitch deck** is whatever the venture uploads. Recommended: allow an optional second-language deck and show the one that matches the investor's language first.

13.7 Staged rollout

1. **Internal:** studio staff and test accounts for 2 to 3 days.
2. **Pilot:** 3 to 5 friendly investors for one to two weeks.
3. **All investors.**

At each step check the Errors register daily, the log for unexpected gaps, and any support messages. Rollback is switching the flags off. Release one flag at a time, in phase order.

Data. A.2, A.3, A.10. Events: `invitation_sent`, `invitation_opened`, `invitation_submitted`, `application_submitted`, `application_approved`, `application_rejected`, `activation_email_sent`, `account_activated`, `terms_accepted`.

Test. Task T1. The full usability study (5 people). The full regression checklist. The full security and hidden-data checks. The complete French and English review by a French speaker. Release criteria in Reference D.

Exit gate. All release criteria in Reference D are met.

14. Reference A: Data tables

All changes are additive. All times are stored in UTC. Amounts store the original value, the currency and the conversion rate used.

ID	Table or change	Purpose	Key fields
A.1	`investor_profiles` (new columns)	Control and consent	`visibility_mode` (deal_flow_only or full_pipeline, default deal_flow_only), `investor_type`, `investor_type_other`, `source` (public_form, invited, manual), `invitation_id`, `language`, `terms_accepted_at`, `terms_version`, `approved_at`, `last_login_at`
A.2	`investor_types` (new)	Studio-managed list	id, name in English, name in French, active, order
A.3	`investor_invitations` (new)	Track invitations	id, email, name, token, sent_by, sent_at, expires_at, opened_at, submitted_at, form_submission_id, status (sent, opened, submitted, expired, revoked)
A.4	`deal_flow_entries` and `deal_flow_decks` (new, or extend campaigns)	A venture that wants to raise	Entry: id, venture_id, status (draft, live, paused, closed), target_amount, currency, instrument (optional), opened_at, opened_by, closed_at, close_reason (raised, withdrawn, expired, other), show_founder_names (yes or no). Deck: id, entry id, file, language, version, uploaded_by, uploaded_at, status (draft, published), download_allowed (default no)

ID	Table or change	Purpose	Key fields
A.5	`introduction_requests` (new)	The request and the decision	id, investor_id, venture_id, deal_flow_entry_id, message, requested_at, status (submitted, under_review, approved, declined, withdrawn), decided_by, decided_at, decline_reason_id, internal_note, workspace_id
A.6	`meeting_slots` and `meetings` (new, or extend relationship meetings)	Scheduling	Slots: id, workspace_id, proposed_by, start_at, duration, proposer_timezone, status (proposed, accepted, countered, expired), responded_at. Meetings: id, workspace_id, start_at, duration, video_link, status (confirmed, rescheduled, held, cancelled, no_show), confirmation_email_sent_at, outcome_code, outcome_note, investor_feedback
A.7	Pipeline entry (new columns)	Investment confirmation	`investment_amount`, `investment_currency`, `investment_instrument`, `investment_date`, `confirmation_status` (pending, confirmed, rejected), `confirmed_by`, `confirmed_at`, `reject_reason_id`
A.8	`investor_activity_log` (new)	Every action	event_id, occurred_at, event_type, investor_id, venture_id, related_id, actor_type (investor, studio, founder, system), actor_id, metadata (JSON: filters used, seconds on deck, old and new values, reasons), session_id, is_internal

ID	Table or change	Purpose	Key fields
A.9	`metric_settings` (new)	Studio-editable settings	key, value, updated_by, updated_at
A.10	`legal_documents` and `legal_acceptances` (new)	NDA and terms	Documents: id, type (terms, nda), language, version, text, active_from. Acceptances: investor_id, document id, accepted_at
A.11	`decline_reasons` (new)	Reason lists	id, applies_to (intro, investment, application, pass), name in English, name in French, active

The venture side uses the existing founder records for the founder count and the founders' country. Nothing new is entered for these.

15. Reference B: Activity log events

Every event is written by the server, never edited, and carries the fields in A.8. The phase in brackets is when it starts being written.

- **Account and onboarding:** `invitation_sent`, `invitation_opened`, `invitation_submitted`, `application_submitted`, `application_approved`, `application_rejected`, `activation_email_sent`, `account_activated`, `terms_accepted` (6); `login` (1); `visibility_mode_changed` (1)
- **Deal flow:** `deal_flow_opened`, `deal_flow_closed`, `deck_published` (3)
- **Browsing:** `list_viewed`, `search_used`, `venture_viewed`, `compare_used` (1); `deck_opened`, `deck_closed` (3)
- **Interest and pipeline:** `watchlist_added`, `watchlist_removed`, `pipeline_added`, `pipeline_stage_changed` (1); `interest_expressed` (2)
- **Introductions:** `intro_requested`, `intro_review_started`, `intro_approved`, `intro_declined`, `intro_withdrawn` (3)
- **Conversation and meetings:** `message_sent`, `message_read`, `message_email_sent`, `slot_proposed`, `slot_accepted`, `meeting_confirmed`, `meeting_email_sent`, `meeting_reminder_sent`, `meeting_rescheduled`, `meeting_cancelled`, `meeting_held`, `meeting_no_show` (4)
- **Investment:** `investment_recorded`, `pipeline_declined`, `pipeline_withdrawn` (5)

The studio can read the log for any investor or venture ('this investor opened this venture on this date'). Investors cannot see the log.

16. Reference C: The metrics matrix

This is the most important part of the system. Every table, field and event above exists so that these metrics can be calculated. When a choice is unclear, choose the option that keeps the metrics accurate.

C.1 Settings and definitions

Setting or definition	Value
Time to close: clock start	A studio setting. Options: first view, first interest, first introduction request, introduction approved. **Default: first introduction request.** The studio will decide. Changing it recalculates every deal.
Time to close: end	The `investment_recorded` date
Averages	Report the **median** and the mean
Unique counts	One investor and one venture count once per period
Exclusions	Studio staff and test accounts are excluded from every metric
Currency	Store the original amount and the rate. Report in XOF and in USD or EUR.
Missing data	Null, never zero
Periods	Every metric can be cut by day, month, quarter and year
Standard cuts	Investor type, investor country, venture industry, venture, deal flow entry, visibility mode

C.2 A. Investor network

ID	Metric	Formula
A1	Applications received	Count of `application_submitted`
A2	Approval rate	Approved ÷ (approved + rejected)
A3	Time to approve	`application_approved` − `application_submitted` (median, days)
A4	Activation rate	`account_activated` ÷ `application_approved`
A5	Time to activate	`account_activated` − `activation_email_sent`
A6	Active investors	Investors with at least 1 `login` in the last 30 days, and as % of approved
A7	Network composition	Approved investors by type, country, industry preference and mode
A8	Invitation conversion	Submitted ÷ sent, and approved ÷ submitted
A9	Source mix	Applications by source (public form, invited, manual)

C.3 B. Deal flow

ID	Metric	Formula
B1	Ventures in deal flow	Count of live entries
B2	Total amount sought	Sum of target amounts of live entries
B3	Days in deal flow	(Close date or today) − opened date
B4	Deal flow outcomes	Closed entries by reason (raised, withdrawn, expired, other)
B5	Deck readiness	Entries with a published deck ÷ entries
B6	Raise success rate	Entries closed as raised ÷ entries closed

C.4 C. Investor engagement

ID	Metric	Formula
C1	Views per venture	Count of `venture_viewed`, and unique investors
C2	Deal flow exposure	Unique investors who viewed ÷ approved investors in a mode that can see it
C3	Deck open rate	Investor-venture pairs with `deck_opened` ÷ pairs with `venture_viewed`
C4	Deck engagement	Average seconds from `deck_closed`
C5	Interest rate	Pairs with `interest_expressed` ÷ pairs with `venture_viewed`
C6	Watchlist adds	Count of `watchlist_added`
C7	Investor activity	Events per active investor per month

C.5 D. Introductions and meetings

ID	Metric	Formula
D1	Introduction requests	Count of `intro_requested`
D2	Approval rate	Approved ÷ (approved + declined)
D3	Time to decide	`decided_at` − `requested_at` (median, hours)
D4	Time to schedule	`meeting_confirmed` − `intro_approved`
D5	Time from request to meeting	Meeting start − `intro_requested`
D6	Meetings held	Count of `meeting_held`
D7	No-show rate	No-shows ÷ (held + no-shows)
D8	Reschedule rate	Rescheduled meetings ÷ confirmed meetings
D9	Decline reasons	Declined requests by reason
D10	Introduction-to-diligence conversion	Approved introductions whose pair reaches Due Diligence ÷ approved introductions

ID	Metric	Formula
D11	Introduction backlog	Requests in submitted or under review, and the age in days of the oldest

C.6 E. Pipeline and investment

ID	Metric	Formula
E1	Pipeline by stage	Count of investor-venture pairs per stage
E2	Step conversion	Pairs that reached the next stage ÷ pairs that reached this stage
E3	Time in stage	Days between `pipeline_stage_changed` events
E4	Interest-to-investment	Confirmed investments ÷ pairs with `interest_expressed`
E5	**Time to close**	`investment_recorded` – the configured clock start
E6	Investments	Count and sum of confirmed amounts, by investor type and venture industry
E7	Average ticket	Sum of confirmed amounts ÷ number of confirmed investments
E8	Loss reasons	Pairs ending as declined or withdrawn, by reason

C.7 F. Studio capital

ID	Metric	Formula
F1	Capital raised by the portfolio	Sum of outside financing events in the period, by type
F2	Outside-to-studio capital ratio	External capital raised ÷ studio capital invested
F3	Platform-originated capital	Capital from investments confirmed here ÷ total outside capital

ID	Metric	Formula
F4	Time to first external funding round	First financing date − venture creation date
F5	Portfolio valuation	Sum of venture valuations. The studio's stake value = valuation × studio ownership %.
F6	TVPI	(Realized proceeds + unrealized stake value) ÷ studio capital invested
F7	DPI	Cash distributed to the studio ÷ studio capital invested, once there are exits
F8	Follow-on capital	Outside financing after the first round

F1 to F4 calculate automatically from the confirmation flow. F5 to F7 need valuation and studio finance inputs that come from outside this platform.

17. Reference D: Testing

D.1 Task scenarios

The moderator gives the task in plain words and does not explain how to do it. Each task has a success rule.

#	Task given to the tester	Success looks like	Phase
T1	'You have just been approved. Log in and tell me what you can do here.'	Finds the checklist and the main areas without help	6
T2	'Find a fintech venture that is raising funds.'	Uses search or a filter and opens one in under 1 minute	2
T3	'Look at their pitch deck.'	The deck opens first with no hunting	3
T4	'You like it. Save it and tell the studio you are interested.'	Uses the one interest button and sees it in the pipeline	2
T5	'Ask for an introduction.'	Finds the button, sends it, sees 'Request sent'	3

#	Task given to the tester	Success looks like	Phase
T6	'What happened to your request?'	Reads the status correctly	3
T7	'Your introduction was approved. Send them a message and book a meeting.'	Messages and schedules in under 3 minutes	4
T8	'Your request was declined. Why?'	Finds and understands the reason	3
T9	'You have put money in. Record it.'	Records it and says it is pending the studio	5
T10	'What do you need to do today?'	Reads the Action needed strip correctly	2 onward
T11	'Switch to French and check your meetings.'	Switches language and all text is in French	2 onward
T12	'Do the same on your phone.'	Completes T2 to T5 on a 360-pixel screen	2 onward
T13	'Add your logo and a note about your past investments.'	Updates the profile	2

D.2 Methods (industry standard)

1. **Heuristic review** against Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics before real users see it.
2. **Moderated usability sessions,** think-aloud, about 45 minutes each, on desktop and phone. Phases 2 and 6: **5 people.** Phases 3 to 5: 3 testers plus 2 team members who have never used the dashboard. Five testers reveal most usability problems.
3. **Measure** per task: completed or not, time, number of errors, and whether help was needed.
4. **System Usability Scale (SUS)** after each session.
5. **Accessibility:** keyboard only, a screen reader pass, a contrast checker, zoom to 200%.
6. **Performance** on a mid-range phone with a throttled 4G connection.
7. **Security and hidden-data checks:** inspect network responses for each mode and confirm no hidden field is ever returned (search, compare and recommendations included). Confirm an investor cannot read another investor's data or an internal decline note.
8. **Regression checklist:** every item recorded in Phase 0 must still pass.

9. **Email checks:** every email renders in English and French on desktop and mobile mail apps, and calendar files open correctly.
10. **Bilingual QA:** a French speaker reviews every screen.

D.3 Severity scale

Severity	Meaning	Rule
Critical	Blocks a task, loses data, exposes hidden data, or breaks an existing action	Fix before the phase gate
High	The task is completed with serious difficulty	Fix before the phase gate
Medium	Causes hesitation or small errors	Fix, or schedule with the product owner's approval
Low	Cosmetic	Backlog

D.4 Release criteria (Phase 6, and the basis of every phase gate)

- No critical or high issue open
- At least 90% of tasks completed without help
- SUS score of 80 or above
- Every item in the baseline regression checklist passes
- WCAG 2.2 AA checks pass on the main screens
- Performance targets (section 9.6) met
- No hidden field returned in any response
- French and English complete

D.5 Defect log

Log each finding with: ID, task or scenario, screen, steps to reproduce, expected versus actual, device and browser, language, severity, screenshot or recording, status. Retest every fix, then rerun the regression checklist.

18. Reference E: Still needed from the product owner

The developer does not need these to begin Phases 0 to 2. They are needed before the phases named.

1. The developer's timeline, and whether she works alone. (All phases)
2. Whether a staging site already exists. (Phase 0)
3. Brand guidelines or design files beyond the `stf-*` kit. (Phase 2)
4. The NDA text in English and French, approved by the studio's legal advisor. (Phase 6)
5. Names of 3 to 5 investors who can test, plus 2 internal testers. (Phases 2 to 6)
6. Whether studio staff may read message threads. Assumed: yes, only permission holders, and stated in the terms. (Phase 4)
7. Who on the venture side receives messages. Assumed: all founders with accounts. (Phase 4)
8. Whether founder names are shown for a given venture. Default: hidden until the studio switches it on. (Phase 3)
9. The time-to-close clock start. Default until decided: first introduction request. (Phase 5)
10. How already-recorded investments are treated when confirmation is introduced. Suggested: the studio reviews them once and marks them confirmed. (Phase 5)